

GENTO KATO

Senior Assistant Professor

School of Political Science and Economics, Meiji University

1-1 Kanda-Surugadai, Chiyoda-ku, Tokyo 101-8301, Japan

gentok@meiji.ac.jp ◇ gento.badger@gmail.com ◇ <https://gentok.github.io/>

Last Updated: May 15, 2026

RESEARCH INTERESTS

General interests. Political behavior, Japanese politics, American politics, political methodology

Substantive interests. Low-information voting logic, political knowledge, cognitive heuristics, voter competence, motivated reasoning, identity politics and gender, media priming/framing, comparative behavior

Methodological interests. Survey research, experiments, formal modeling, EITM, causal inference, text analysis, machine learning, agent-based simulations, Bayesian statistics, measurements/scaling

POSITIONS

Meiji University, Tokyo, Japan Sep. 2023-
Senior Assistant Professor, School of Political Science and Economics

Nazarbayev University, Astana, Kazakhstan Aug. 2020-Jun. 2023
Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science and International Relations

Yale University, New Haven, CT Sep. 2021-May 2022
Postdoctoral Associate and Lecturer, Council on East Asian Studies

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science, University of California, Davis, Davis, CA Jun. 2020
Dissertation: *How Uninformed Voters Respond to Electoral Environment and Why It Matters: The Contextual Logic and Consequences of Low-Information Voting*
Advisers: Robert Huckfeldt, Ph.D., Cheryl Boudreau, Ph.D., Ryan Hübert, Ph.D.

M.A. in Political Science, Waseda University, Tokyo, Japan Mar. 2015
Master's Thesis: *Participate with Uncertainty? What "Don't Know" Responses and a Response Time Reveal About Political Awareness and Political Participation*
Advisers: Aiji Tanaka, Ph.D., Airo Hino, Ph.D.

B.A. in Politics, International Christian University, Tokyo, Japan Mar. 2012

Study abroad program, Middlebury College, Middlebury, VT Aug. 2010-May 2011

SUMMER PROGRAM

EITM Summer Institute, Emory University, Atlanta, GA Jul. 2019

Institute for Political Methodology, Academia Sinica, Taipei, Taiwan Jul. 2015

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research, Ann Arbor, MI Jun.-Jul. 2014

The Summer Institute in Political Psychology, Stanford University, Palo Alto, CA Jul.-Aug. 2012

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Annaka, Susumu, Masaaki Higashijima, and **Gento Kato** (2026) "Government Information and Popular Reactions in Autocracies: An Information Correction Experiment on COVID-19 in Kazakhstan," *Political Studies*. (Joint First Author; Corresponding Author)

- Hamzawi, Jordan, **Gento Kato**, and Masahisa Endo (2025) "What Brings You to the Party? Voter Preferences on Parties Through Policy and Valence Dynamics," *Party Politics*. (Joint First Author; Corresponding Author)
- Kato, Gento**, Fan Lu, and Masahisa Endo (2025) "The Preference-expectation Gap in Support for Female Candidates: Evidence from Japan," *Public Opinion Quarterly* 89(1), 217–228.
- Adhikari, Bimal and **Gento Kato** (2024) "Russian Adventurism and Central Asian Leaders' Foreign Policy Rhetoric: Evidence from the UN General Debate Corpus," *Research & Politics*, 1-8. (Published online first on May 16, 2024; Joint First Author)
- Kato, Gento** and Fan Lu (2023) "The Relationship between University Education and Pro-Immigrant Attitudes Varies by Generation: Insights from Japan," *International Journal of Public Opinion Research* 35(4), 1-12. (Published online first October 28, 2023)
- Annaka, Susumu, and **Gento Kato** (2022) "Can a Constitutional Monarch Influence Democratic Preferences? Japanese Emperor and the Regulation of Public Expression," *Social Science Quarterly* 103(3), 699-708. (Joint First Author; Corresponding Author)
- Kato, Gento** (2020) "When Strategic Uninformed Abstention Improves Democratic Accountability," *Journal of Theoretical Politics* 32(3), 366-388.
- Kohno, Masaru, Gabriella R. Montinola, Matthew S. Winters, and **Gento Kato** (2021) "Donor Competition and Public Support for Foreign Aid Sanctions," *Political Research Quarterly* 74(1), 212-227. (Published online first on February 17, 2020)
- Collet, Christian and **Gento Kato** (2014) "Does NHK Make You Smarter (and Super News Make You 'Softer')? An Examination of Japanese Political Knowledge and the Potential Influence of TV News," *Japanese Journal of Political Science* 15(1), 23-50.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS (IN JAPANESE)

- Kato, Gento**, Kazuyoshi Inagaki, Takato Iio, and Shunsuke Taguchi (Forthcoming) "Does a Mismatch Between Appearance and Policy Hinder Candidate Choice? Experimental Evidence on the Effect of Age Cues in Candidates' Appearance on Issue Voting," *Japanese Journal of Electoral Studies*. (In Japanese) (加藤言人・稲垣和由・飯尾天翔・田口俊介 (近刊予定) 「外見と政策の不一致は候補者選択を阻害するか? 候補者の外見年齢が争点投票に与える影響に関するサーベイ実験」, 『選挙研究』.)
- Annaka, Susumu, Junpei Suzuki, and **Gento Kato** (2022) "Universalist Social Benefit and Regressive Taxation as Determinants of Welfare State Support: Survey Experiment on Consumption Tax Hike in Japan," *The Annals of Japanese Political Science Association* 2022-I, 212-235. (In Japanese) (安中進・鈴木淳平・加藤言人 (2022) 「福祉国家に対する態度決定要因としての普遍的社会保障と逆進課税: 消費増税に関するサーヴェイ実験」, 『年報政治学』 2022-I, 212-235.)
- Kato, Gento** and Susumu Annaka (2020) "Explaining 'Twisted' Preferences Toward Monetary Easing in Japan: Experimental Evidence on the Effect of Information Environment on the Relationship Between Ideology and Policy Preferences," *Japanese Journal of Electoral Studies* 36(2), 151-167. (In Japanese) (加藤言人・安中進 (2020) 「日本における「ねじれ」た金融緩和選好を説明する: イデオロギーと政策選好の関係に情報環境が与える影響の実験的検証」, 『選挙研究』 36(2), 151-167.)

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- Kato, Gento** (2025) "Mutohaso to Sosharu Nettowaku Kankyo [Independents and Social Network Environments]," In Aiji Tanaka, Masahisa Endo, Norihiro Mimura, and Arata Yamazaki eds. *Mutohaso no Kenkyu [Study of Independents in Japan]*, Tokyo: Yuhikaku. (In Japanese) (加藤言人 (2025), 「無党派層とソーシャルネットワーク環境」, 田中愛治 (監) 遠藤晶久・三村憲弘・山崎新 (編) 『無党派の研究』 有斐閣.)

Endo, Masahisa and **Gento Kato** (2022) "Social Values and Mask-wearing Behaviour During the COVID-19 Pandemic in Japan," In Noriko Suzuki, Xavier Mellet, Susumu Annaka and Masahisa Endo eds. *Public Behavioural Responses to Policy Making during the Pandemic: Comparative Perspectives on Mask Wearing Policies*, Routledge.

SELECTED MEDIA APPEARANCES

ABEMA TIMES (2025) 「女性候補は勝ちにくい」は思い込み？女性やりベラル層ほど“ズレ”深刻？“戦略的差別”が政治に与える影響とは？精神科医「『政治家＝男性』という方程式が」, *Abemaヒルズ*, <https://times.abema.tv/articles/-/10186895> (Published July 5, 2025)

Annaka, Susumu and **Gento Kato** (2023) "The King and Aye: When Monarchs Influence the People," *360info*, <https://360info.org/the-king-and-aye-when-monarchs-influence-the-people/> (Published May 5, 2023).

SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

(Single Authored)

How voters form factual beliefs about female political leaders and what we can learn from them: Insights from Japan Feb. 2026
Under review.

Local bandwagoning and national balancing: How uninformed voters respond to the partisan environment Sep. 2019

(Co-authored)

Black Lives Matter and anti-Black prejudice in non-WEIRD countries: Evidence from Japan Mar. 2026
Under review. First author. Coauthored with Fan Lu.

The preference-expectation gap and its consequences for candidates from under-represented backgrounds Mar. 2026
Under review. First author. Coauthored with Fan Lu.

Personal values or a democratic value? Revisiting public reactions to the failure of civilian control in Japan Feb. 2026
Under review. First author. Coauthored with Yuma Oshida, Rikuto Oi, Hiroyoshi Shibata, and Shogo Karube.

Household analogy revisited: How do Japanese people respond to government borrowing and assets? Feb. 2026
Under review. With Junpei Suzuki, Susumu Annaka, and Takaharu Saito.

The impact of elections on civic attitudes: Causal evidence from Kazakhstan's staggered local elections Jul. 2025
Under review. With Masaaki Higashijima and Yuki Shiraito.

Can a political incorporation of youth cultivate regime support in autocracies? Evidence from Kazakhstan Apr. 2025
First author. Coauthored with Assel Bekenova.

A formal model of shared identity appeals Sep. 2022
First author. Coauthored with Fan Lu.

Reexamining the effect of democratization on respect for human rights in sub-Saharan Africa, 1978-2008 Aug. 2022
Joint first author with Bimal Adhikari and Jeffrey King.

Socioeconomic inequality and COVID-19 prevalence across municipalities in Catalonia, Spain May 2020
With Ryohei Mogi and Susumu Annaka.

HONORS & AWARDS

<i>Social Policy Grant, Nazarbayev University (\$10,000)</i>	2022-23
<i>Merk Prospectus Award, Department of Political Science, UC Davis (\$4,000)</i>	2019
<i>Provost's Dissertation Year Fellowship, Graduate Studies, UC Davis (\$43,200)</i>	2019-20
<i>Dissertation Improvement Award, Department of Political Science, UC Davis (\$2,500)</i>	2019
<i>Summer Collaborative Award, Department of Political Science, UC Davis (\$5,000)</i> <i>With Professor Adrienne Hosek.</i>	Summer 2018
<i>Graduate Scholarship for Degree Seeking Students, Japan Student Services Organization</i>	2015-20
<i>Ijima Award, Graduate School of Political Science, Waseda University</i>	2015
<i>The Best Master Thesis Award, Graduate School of Political Science, Waseda University</i>	2015
<i>Azusa Ono Memorial Award, Waseda University</i>	2015
<i>Okuma Memorial Scholarship, Waseda University</i>	2014
<i>125th Anniversary Scholarship, Waseda University</i>	2013

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

<i>American Political Science Association Annual Meeting</i>	2014, 2017, 2019-23
<i>Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference</i>	2014, 2017, 2019, 2022, 2024
<i>Western Political Science Association Annual Meeting</i>	2025
<i>International Political Science Association World Congress</i>	2025
<i>World Association for Public Opinion Research Asia-Pacific Chapter Annual Conference</i>	2025
<i>PolMeth (The Society for Political Methodology Annual Summer Meeting)</i>	2020
<i>Japanese Political Science Association Annual Meeting</i>	2019, 2023
<i>Japanese Association of Electoral Studies Annual Conference</i>	2015, 2021
<i>International Studies Association Asia-Pacific Region Conference</i>	2023
<i>Asian Politics Online Seminar Series</i>	Sep. 2021
<i>Japanese Politics Online Seminar Series</i>	Oct. 2020
<i>Toronto Political Behaviour Workshop</i>	Nov. 2019

RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

<i>EGAP Metaketa Initiative</i> <i>Member of third-party experiment replication team</i>	2019-20
<i>Institute of Applied Social Psychology + Connect, Osaka, Japan</i> <i>Assistant researcher</i>	2012-13, 2016

TEACHING

<i>POL311J: 政治過程論 [Theories of Political Process] (in Japanese), Meiji University</i>	Fall 2023-
<i>政治意識論 I&II [Political Psychology] (in Japanese), Gakushuin University</i>	Spring 2024-
<i>PLS434/534: Text Analysis and Political Communication in the Information Age, Nazarbayev University</i>	Spring 2023 [†]
<i>PLS140: Introduction to Comparative Politics, Nazarbayev University</i>	Fall 2022

PLSC162/678: Japan and the World , Yale University Co-teaching with Professor Frances Rosenbluth	Fall 2021 [†]
PLS416/516: Experimental Political Science , Nazarbayev University	Spring 2021 [†]
PLS211: Quantitative Methods , Nazarbayev University	Spring 2021
PLS415/515: Maximum Likelihood Models , Nazarbayev University	Fall 2020/2022 [†]
PLS312: Public Opinion and Elections , Nazarbayev University	Fall 2020/Spring 2023
POL 051: Scientific Study of Politics , UC Davis	Spring 2018

[†]Courses that are open to both undergraduate and graduate students.

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Member, American Political Science Association	2014-
Member, Midwest Political Science Association	2014-
Member, Japanese Political Science Association	2019-
Member, Japanese Association of Electoral Studies	2014-

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Master Thesis Committee Member for: Kamila Matzhanova (Nazarbayev University, 2021), Ali Mukhambet (Nazarbayev University, 2021), Aigerim Aibassova (Nazarbayev University, 2022), Aisulu Makhtayeva (Nazarbayev University, 2023), Temirlan Zhumadilov (Nazarbayev University, 2023), and Diana Maratova (Nazarbayev University, 2024)	2021-
Doctoral Thesis Advisory Committee Member for: Aigerim Aibassova (Nazarbayev University, 2023-)	2023-
Journal Reviewer American Journal of Political Science, The Journal of Politics, Political Analysis, International Journal of Public Opinion Research, Comparative Political Studies, Representation, Journal of East Asian Studies, Journal of Asian and African Studies, Communist and Post-Communist Studies, Journal of Regional Research, Ajia Keizai (アジア経済), and Senkyo Kenkyu (選挙研究)	2020-
Discussant Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference, American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Japanese Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2019-

OTHER SERVICES

Associate Researcher , Waseda Institute of Political Economy, Waseda University	2021-
Mentor , Japanese Club, Nazarbayev University	2022-23
Assistant Coordinator , Political Science Research Workshop, UC Davis	2019-20
Mentor , First Friends Program, UC Davis	2016-17

SKILLS

Computing: R, Stata, SPSS, Python (including oTree) and L^AT_EX
Languages: Japanese (native) and English (highly proficient)